

Tekken 9 Release Date, Characters & What Will Be Its Story Plot?

Bandai Namco's fighting game franchise, Tekken, has long stood as one of the most iconic fighting series in the world. The Tekken franchise has 8 games, ranging from Tekken to Tekken 8, which was released in early 2024. Tekken 8 received a lot of attention, and now Tekken fans are excited after they heard credible rumours and leaks about Tekken 9.

While Bandai Namco officially did not confirm the next release of the Tekken franchise, several leaks, story hints, and interviews suggest that we might expect when Tekken 9 will be released. Let's explore all the rumours and facts about the potential release of Tekken 9.

Tekken 9 Release Date: When Could It Arrive?

As stated, there has been no official announcement from Bandai Namco about the release of Tekken 9. Looking at the previous Tekken franchise release dates, Tekken 7 was launched in 2015, and Tekken 8 arrived globally in early 2024. So this pattern suggests that Bandai Namco takes around five to six years to launch the next Tekken. Now, If the studio follows the same timeline, then the Tekken 9 might be released around 2029 or 2030.

However, Bandai Namco's game developer Katsuhiro Harada and Michael Murray have hinted that the game could be released with Sony's upcoming next-gen PlayStation 6 and Xbox. Still, no official release date has been confirmed yet. A few unofficial sources suggest that Tekken 9 could be launched as early as 2028, while others say it could be delayed until 2029.

Tekken 8 has faced backlash due to its unresolved storylines, so we can definitely assume that Bandai Namco will release the next chapter. Additionally, from the director's side, it could be released alongside with PS6, meaning the development could be quicker.

Expected Characters in Tekken 9

The Tekken series is known for its large and diverse cast, and based on leaks and fan discussions, then most likely Tekken 9 will continue this tradition too. Tekken fans can expect both old veterans and new characters in the game.

Here are the most likely confirmed and returning characters:

- **Jin Kazama** – After defeating his father, Kazuya in *Tekken 8*, Jin will most likely be the central protagonist.
- **Kazuya Mishima** – It's hard to imagine a Tekken game without Kazuya Mishima, even though he seems to have lost. He might reappear in a more sinister form or even be resurrected.
- **Jun Kazama** – Jun Kazama was officially back in *Tekken 8*, and he could play a more important role in shaping the world after the Mishima war.
- **Hwoarang, Lars Alexandersson, and Nina Williams** – Core fighters who are deeply tied to the Mishima storyline will probably return.
- **New Generation Fighters** – Bandai Namco may introduce new characters from different regions to expand global diversity.

Talking about the rumours, then Tekken fans can expect a few guest characters like Tifa Lockhart from Final Fantasy and Johnny Cage from Mortal Kombat. If these leaks prove to be true, then Tekken 9 could offer more than 50 playable characters with new stages, modes, and rewards.

Tekken 9 Story Plot: What's Next After Tekken 8?

Bandai Namco was making sure that after finishing Tekken 8, fans would wait and keep thinking about how Tekken 9 would continue the storyline and plots. That's why Tekken 8 ended up with long-running plots revolving around the Mishima Family.

Talking about the in-game storyline, Tekken 8 concluded with the redemption of Jin Kazama and how he defeats Kazuya Mishima's Devil side, with Heihachi long gone. Now this suggests that the new game may introduce a totally fresh plot and new antagonists. One of the expected new faces, Reina, is supposed to play a crucial villain role, making her the new antagonist for the ongoing conflict.

If we think that what possibly could be the storyline for Tekken 9, some conclusions are:

- The fall of Mishima Zaibatsu and G Corporation could create a power vacuum that will eventually give rise to a new antagonist seeking control over the world.
- While Jin seemingly became comfortable with the Devil Gene - remnants of which will linger on to create psychological and emotional issues for him.

- The plot will be shifted away from Mishima's legacy, exploring new rivalries and alliances. Since Tekken's lore is filled with supernatural forces and secret organizations, we may see Reina rising.
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Final Thoughts

Since Tekken 9 has not been officially confirmed by Bandai Namco, we can expect its launch most likely in 2028-2029, possibly with PlayStation 6's launch.

If the leaks and rumours hold true, then Tekken 9 could be the biggest asset for Bandai Namco. The success of Tekken 8 will ensure that the next game in this franchise gives a fresh dramatic storyline and memorable characters, marking a new era in combat games.

Sources:

- Tekken subreddit community discussions
 - Previous game timelines and developer hints
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